



“*Shri Ram Gopal Agarwal, Founder Chairman of Dhanuka Agritech Ltd., is an inspiring and legendary name for relentlessly transforming India's agricultural landscape with his commitment, knowledge, expertise and compassion. Under his visionary guidance, the business metamorphosed into one of the fastest growing agrochemical Company in India and rated thrice as 'Best under a Billion Company' by Forbes magazine.*”

Dr. R G Agarwal,
Chairman Emeritus, Dhanuka Agritech

Driving Five Decades of Scientific Agri Practices to Empower Farmers

With over four decades of leadership in the agricultural industry, could you reflect on your enriching journey and highlight Dhanuka's key contributions to strengthening and empowering India's agricultural ecosystem?

I come from a family with a business background and pursued my education at Shri Ram College of Commerce. Initially, Our family business was focused on textiles but following the Indo-Pak war, we decided to shift our focus towards agriculture. Inspired by the vision of Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri, particularly his slogan “Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan” and his personal commitment to working in the fields, I found my true calling in the agricultural sector. This was further motivated by the experience of being forced to eat wheat received under PL-480, as our food security was ship-to-mouth with no alternatives available, which led me to transition from textiles to agriculture.

Over 55 years ago, after completing my graduation, I embarked on an entrepreneurial journey in agriculture, beginning by educating farmers and providing them with essential agrochemicals. This initiative aimed at introducing modern farming techniques, which had a profound positive impact on their productivity and livelihoods recognized subsequently as Green Revolution in India. In 1985, we founded Dhanuka Agritech, building on the legacy of my earlier ventures. Today, Dhanuka is a leading player in the agricultural industry, with

four manufacturing units and a reach that extends to over 10 million farmers across India.

Our company has always been at the forefront of introducing cutting-edge technologies to improve farming practices. We have strategic partnerships with six Japanese companies, which enable us to bring the latest agricultural technologies to Indian farmers. We currently employ over 1,500 people on the ground who work tirelessly to educate farmers about modern agricultural practices and provide them with innovative solutions. Beyond conventional products, we are pioneering the use of drones for precise application of agri-inputs, weather stations and ICT based predictions of epidemics of pests and diseases, hunger signs based nutrient application and IoT solutions, and various other technologies to enhance farm productivity. Dhanuka is committed to leaving no stone unturned when it comes to supporting India's farmers and improving the agricultural ecosystem in the country.

Knowledge sharing is pivotal to cultivating crops that are locally adapted yet meet global quality standards. Could you elaborate on this concept and discuss Dhanuka's initiatives in empowering farmers to embrace scientific agricultural practices?

At Dhanuka, we practice on the ideology of “seeing is believing”. When it comes to educating and convincing the farmers about the real advantages of our tech solutions, we engage them through

demonstrations, field days, and digital platforms. One significant initiative was our public-private partnership with the Government of Madhya Pradesh in Hoshangabad, where we educated farmers on our latest products, resulting in a 30-40% yield increase over three years that resulted in crowning the region with the Best District Award.

In March 2024, we signed an MOU with ICAR to collaborate on extension and research, reaching farmers through educational materials like posters and videos. Within 6 months of our collaboration, we could connect farmers with scientists of more than 600 out of 731 KVKs under nine out of eleven ATARIs located across the length and breadth of the country. We also launched mobile vans in states such as Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, UP, Maharashtra, and Haryana, educating farmers on QR-code based product authenticity thus ensuring purchase of genuine products against original bills.

Additionally, we've conducted trials at universities like PDKV Akola and SKRAU Bikaner, where our products have shown significant yield improvements—17% for soybean and 80% for groundnuts. Through such self-convincing efforts, we aim at spreading science based agricultural practices across India to boost farmers' yields and income.

From an agricultural perspective, what are the key challenges in achieving the Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision of Viksit Bharat? Additionally,